

Assignment 1

Surrealistic collage
and short essay

CART 498B

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My Current Understanding of Generative AI and Its Applications in Creative Fields.

My understanding of generative AI initially came from using tools well-known platforms such as ChatGPT and Microsoft Copilot for text-based tasks. Most of my experience with AI has been in a professional context, where I use it to help draft emails, generate ideas, summarize information, and perform other productivity-related tasks. In these situations, AI serves as a helpful tool that can save time and improve efficiency.

As a designer, however, I have not relied heavily on AI in creative related tasks aside from brainstorming ideas. One of the reasons is that I highly value the human side of the creative process as creativity is often shaped by emotions, reasoning, and cultural influences. While generative AI can produce impressive results and assist with ideas, I believe that genuine human creativity cannot be fully replicated by a machine. The ability to communicate meaning, tell stories, and create emotional connections remains a unique human strength.

Despite my initial skepticism, I recognize that generative AI is a technology that cannot simply be ignored. It is already transforming many creative industries, including graphic design, photography, music, film, and visual arts. Rather than replacing artists and designers, I see AI becoming an increasingly important tool that can support creative work processes.

One generative AI artwork that particularly inspires me is *Memories of Passersby I* (2019) by Mario Klingemann. This autonomous installation continuously generates an endless stream of portraits using artificial intelligence. What fascinates me most is that the artwork is never the same, it is constantly evolving and creating new faces. The piece challenged my assumptions about AI and creativity by demonstrating how artificial intelligence can be used as a medium for artistic expression and showed me that AI can also have a place in the creative world while still leaving room for human interpretation and appreciation.